

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Transparency to consequence

TRANSPARENCY -> visibility of records, spending and decisions

ANSWERABILITY -> an identifiable authority obliged to explain

ENFORCEABILITY -> correction, remedy or consequence

INDIAN PATTERN -> first built extensively, second unevenly, third rarely

MUST REMEMBER: Accountability requires an actor, forum, information, questioning,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Information-request route card

ORDINARY REPLY -> 30 days from the public information officer

LIFE OR LIBERTY -> 48 hours

APPEALS -> first appeal ordinarily within 30 days; second appeal within 90 days

PENALTY -> two hundred and fifty rupees per day up to twenty-five thousand rupees

LIMIT -> obtains existing information; cannot create it or order a service

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Exemptions and the override

EXEMPTIONS -> section 8, applied clause by clause

SEVERABILITY -> an exempt part does not withhold the whole record

OVERRIDE -> section 8(2) permits disclosure where public interest outweighs harm

EXCLUSION -> section 24 for listed organisations, with corruption and rights provisos preserved

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The substituted exemption

BEFORE -> the pre-substitution personal-information test, now superseded

13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025 -> section 44(3) substitution takes effect in the immediate tranche

UNAFFECTED -> the section 8(2) public-interest override remains available

PENDING -> constitutional challenges filed; no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026

ASCLII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Social audit statutory basis

SECTION 17 -> the Gram Sabha holds the monitoring and social-audit function

RULES OF 2011 -> an independent State Social Audit Unit facilitates the audit

CYCLE -> at least once every six months in every Gram Panchayat

COMPLETION -> public hearing followed by a mandated follow-up process

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Two layers, one audit

COMMUNITY LAYER -> local knowledge, public legitimacy, presence of the affected people

INDEPENDENT UNIT -> facilitation, record access, training, separation from the implementer

CAPTURE RISK -> present at both layers and not removed by either alone

TRADE-OFF -> more independence reduces capture and reduces hyper-local knowledge

CLOSE DISTINCTION: RTI disclosure is not grievance adjudication, CAG audit is not...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Two tests that decide quality

INDEPENDENCE TEST -> is the facilitator structurally separate from the audited department

FOLLOW-UP TEST -> does a finding trigger timed recovery, discipline or process correction

ANSWERABILITY -> produced by the public hearing itself

ENFORCEABILITY -> produced only by the mandated action-taken process

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Visibility to correction

DISCLOSURE -> published but sometimes aggregated, technical or stale

COMPREHENSION -> intelligible to the affected person, in their own language

VERIFICATION -> record compared against reality by an independent facilitator

ANSWERABILITY -> a named official explains in public, on the record

FOLLOW-UP AND CONSEQUENCE -> action-taken report, recovery, discipline; the usual break point

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Accountability typology

HORIZONTAL -> public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, ombudsman, courts, regulators

VERTICAL -> elections, legislative questioning, political competition

SOCIAL -> information requests, social audit, public hearings, report cards, media

COUPLING RULE -> social answerability needs a horizontal instrument to supply consequence

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Institutional division of labour

PUBLIC AUDITOR -> Articles 148 to 151; financial, compliance and performance audit

VIGILANCE COMMISSION -> Act of 2003; superintendence and advice, not conviction

CORRUPTION OMBUDSMAN -> Act of 2013; inquiry into covered corruption complaints

GRIEVANCE PLATFORM -> 21-day redress and 30-day appeal benchmarks, August 2024 guidelines

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Routing the remedy

INFORMATION DENIED -> public information officer, first appeal, Information Commission

SERVICE DELAYED -> department, notified service-guarantee route, grievance platform

MONEY MISUSED -> social audit, performance audit, legislative scrutiny

CORRUPTION -> vigilance, corruption ombudsman, investigative agency

PERSONAL-DATA BREACH -> not an operative route until the Board is appointed and duties commence

ASCTI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for an accountability demand

OPEN -> transparency, answerability and enforceability separated in sentence one

BUILD -> map the ecosystem, then apply the independence and follow-up tests to one case

CORRECT -> mandated action-taken process, independent facilitation, protection for reporters

CLOSE -> graded verdict, current-status caveat with dates, and stated question ownership

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Apply RTI Act sections 4, 8, 10, 19 and 20...